

Non-Traditional Digital Avatar:

Codeforces profile is not a digital face and there are not even pictures and descriptions. What I use as face and features are graph, color, ranking, these stats demonstrate my problem solving and competitive skills. They reflect what kind of person I am in this competitive field, but not my appearance. Every climb and fall in my rating is self-earned. It's like my experience on solving problems leaves traces, they speak for me, and this reflects what recruiters and people see from my profile: my problem-solving capacity.

Non-Traditional Non-Digital Avatar:

This abstract human-shaped floor lamp is my non-digital avatar. Strictly speaking it's home décor, but truthfully, it feels more like a physical stand-in for myself in my space. When visitors arrive, the lamp emanates an air of calm order with a touch of whimsy. It's the stylized human form itself, plus the act of illumination, that lend it this social presence-as if it were me when I am away, indicating that someone thoughtful, modern, and always seeking a bright idea lives here.

Comparative Analysis:

Seeing these two avatars next to each other presents me with two utterly opposed aspects of self. The floor lamp is concerned with looks and an abstract humanity, curves giving it almost a feeling of life even though it is merely an inanimate object, and giving off an air of being creative and "real" when simply existing in a space. However, it lacks agency entirely; nothing that is done is an action that is performed by the floor lamp itself, it simply exists. My Codeforces profile on the other hand is concerned solely with a display of mental capability and pays no mind to my physical appearance or what persona I would project to the world. It contains very little visually which could be described as "human," and instead it shows sheer intellectual muscle through the figures and graphs it contains; every increase in my rating comes from an action on my part. It's almost entirely about action and proof of my mental acuity, and completely misses all elements of warmth, personality, or a physical presence.